



DELHI | The Legal Hand

Lawyers had a special place in the Congress movement of yester-years, especially during the Freedom Struggle under inimitable lawyer Mohandas Karamchand Gandhi. The party now wants to bring its lawyer friends back to the fold. The effort got off the blocks during the recent National Convention on Law, Justice and the Common Man in the capital. The convention brought together over 2,200 legal activists, lawyers from Congress legal cells in the states and other party-affiliated lawyers. Organised by the AICC legal cell led by Congress spokesman and prominent lawyer Abhishek Singhvi, the meet was graced by the who's who of the Congress—Prime Minister Manmohan Singh, Congress President Sonia Gandhi, Finance Minister Pranab Mukherjee, Home Minister P. Chidambaram, Union Law Minister Veerappa Moily and other top Congress leaders and ministers. "The outpouring of support and emotion for the Congress party by the most influential section of society will be channelled into a mass movement with these soldiers of the Congress activated from the block level upwards," said Singhvi. Moily added, "We can form domain expertise using their experience and ultimately bond them into mainstream of judiciary." The Congress plans to gain from the lawyers' network by using them as crutches while dealing with local issues and creating a legal support system. *by Shafi Rahman*

MANMOHAN,
SINGHVI AND
SONIA AT THE
CONVENTION

2200

legal activists,
lawyers from
Congress
legal cells and
other party-
affiliated
lawyers
attended the
convention.